Table of Contents

iMotions Lab > Remote Data Collection (RDC)

Participating in RDC Studies 2

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Participating in RDC Studies

This article provides an overview and recommendations for participating in an iMotions Remote Data Collection study.

Participant Requirements and Recommendations

This section provides a list of requirements and recommendations for participation in Remote Data Collection studies.

Consent and General Instructions for Participation:

Before participating in any iMotions RDC study, respondents are informed that participation involves displaying media and recording from their computer camera. Respondents must consent to participation and follow the instructions on the iMotions pages. This requires enabling camera recordings and microphone recordings (when applicable) and remaining in position, facing the camera throughout participation.

Technical Participant Requirements:

- Participation in a RDC study requires a desktop or laptop computer with internet access and a supported browser.
- Participation can not be done on phones or tablets.
- Participation must be done on supported browsers: *Chrome*, *Firefox*, *Edge, or Safari (Internet Explorer is not supported).*
- Before participating, we recommend respondents update their internet browser to the latest version.
- Participation with unsupported and non-updated browsers may interfere with the study and result in unusable data files.
- Participation must be done on support operating systems: *Windows 10*, *Apple OSX*, *Chrome OS*
- Participant cameras must provide compatible video file formats: *mp4* or *wmv* (*webm* format is not supported)

Additional Recommendations for Participants:

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The following recommendations can facilitate data collection. These recommendations help ensure that camera recordings have a clear view of the participant's face throughout the study, which is critical for data quality.

- Participation must be done while sitting at a desk with adequate lighting - as described in the RDC instructions at the start of participation.
- Ideally, participants would be in a distraction-free space on a fixed-position chair (avoiding rolling or reclining chairs) to minimize movement.
- Ideally, participation, and the resulting camera recordings, would be in front of a plain background with only the participant's face in view.
- Direct light and other faces (like other people, photos, art, etc.) should not appear in the background of the camera recording - to avoid interference with eye tracking and facial expression analysis.
- Participant cameras should be positioned on the top-center of the screen used for study participation. Other camera locations can decrease eye tracking accuracy (but does not affect facial expression analysis).
- Multi-screen computers require that participants select the correct screen for recording, i.e. displaying the RDC study (single-screen configurations can circumvent problems with screen recordings).
- Default computer and browser configurations are ideal for RDC participation. Study stimuli and/or data collection may be affected by other software or custom settings on participant computers. This includes security, privacy, or graphics software, browser add-ons, extensions, options, etc.

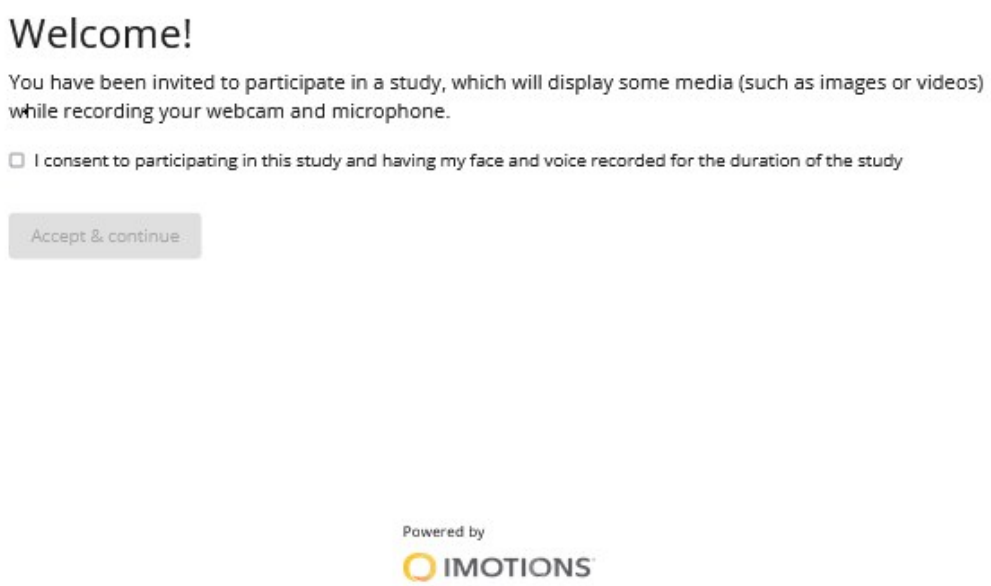
Overview of Participant Experience

This section provides an overview of the participant experience after clicking on an RDC study link. Participation in all RDC studies will begins with study setup and checking audio-visual inputs/output. Participation concludes after the automatic upload of data files to my.imotions.com.

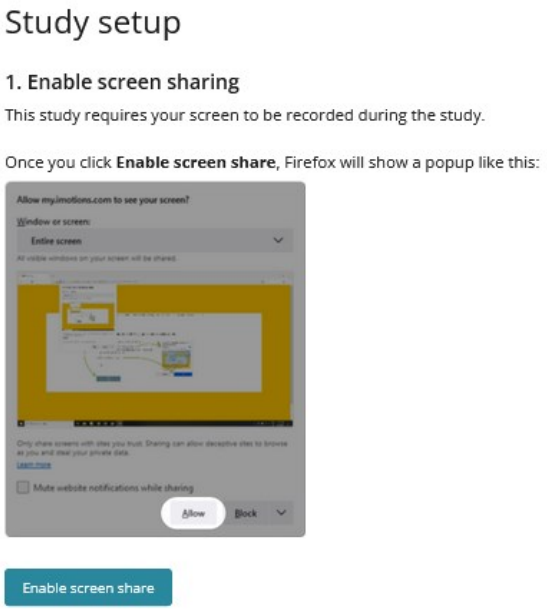
Click here to download a video

1. Clicking on an RDC study link will open an internet browser to the iMotions Welcome/consent screen. The consent form needs to be checked and accepted to proceed with participation.

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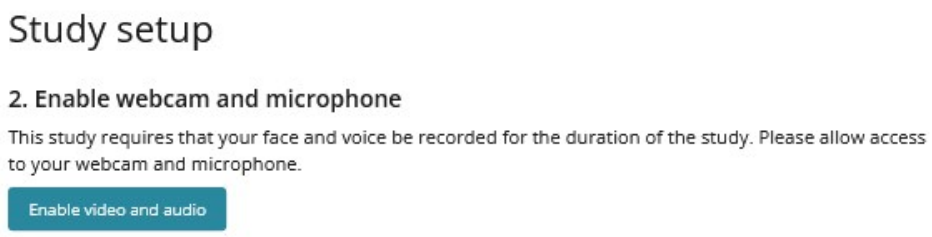
2. *Study setup* pages provide instructions for participation, according the study settings selected on my.imotions.com(e.g. enabling audio or microphone recordings, head positions checks, etc.). The following pages appear when all settings are enabled.
    a. *Enable screen sharing* - Participants must enable screen sharing for screen recording and select the screen (or the browser window) where the RDC study will be shown.

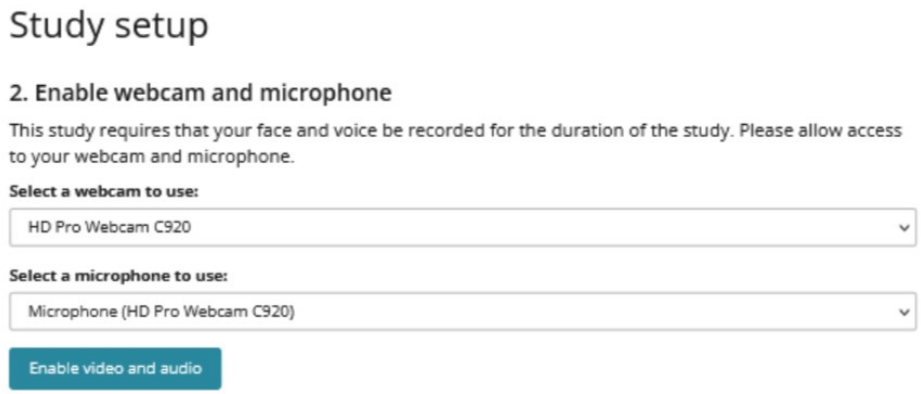


    b. *Enable webcam and microphone* - All RDC studies require enabling access to the participant web camera. If *Record the participant's microphone* is enabled in study settings, participants must also enable access to their microphone. Participants must

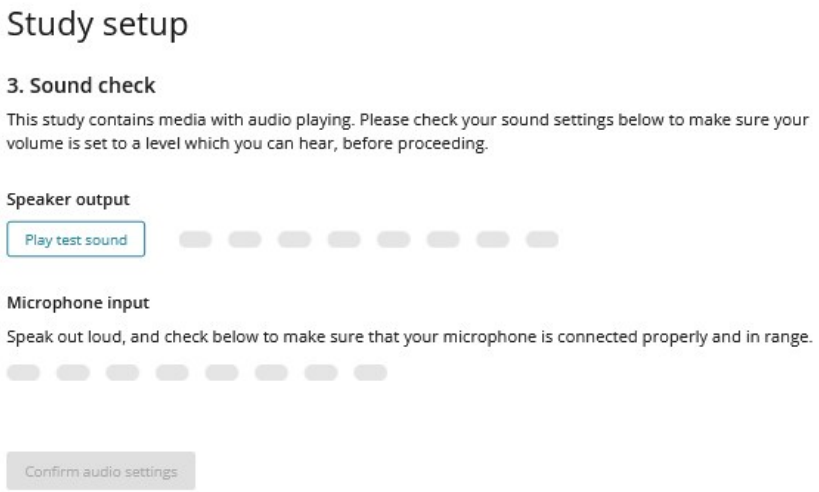
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select the camera and microphone from the drop-down list on this page. Once enabled and selected, the camera video feed will be shown.

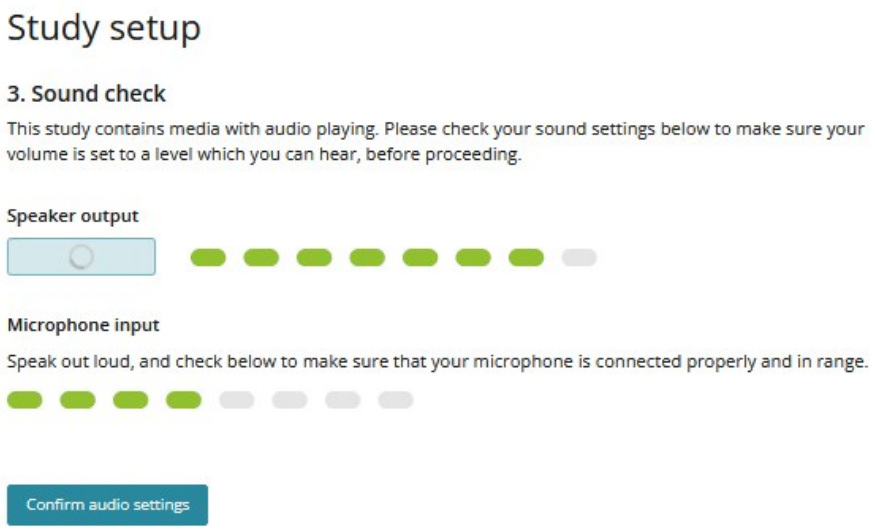




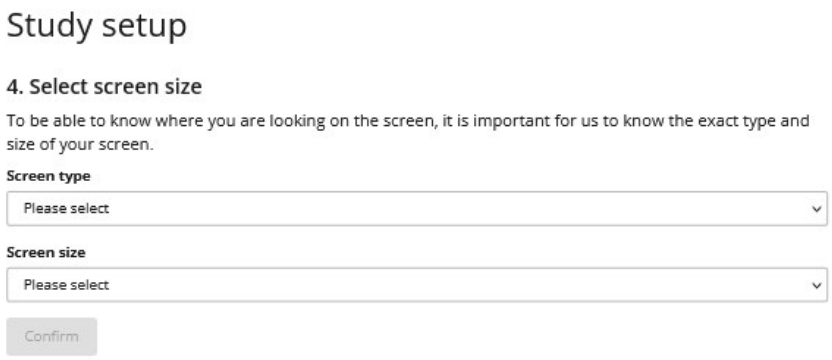
c. *Sound check* - If *Audio output check* and/or *Microphone check* are enabled, participants must pass these checks before proceeding. The *Play test sound* button will check the audio output, while speaking into the microphone will check the audio input.



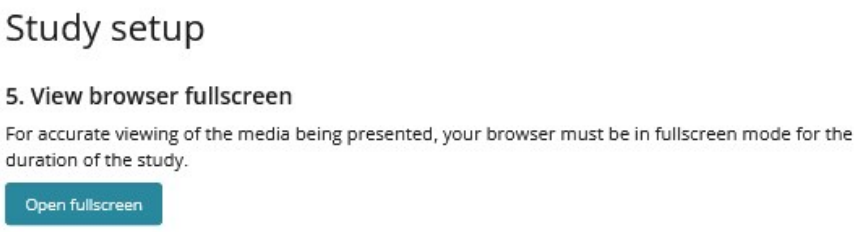
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d. *Select screen size* - Participants must select *Screen type* (either Laptop or Desktop) and *Screen size* (diagonal size in inches). This is important for eye tracking data



e. *View browser fullscreen* - The final study setup page requires that participants click the *Open fullscreen* button to proceed. The browser will remain in fullscreen mode until the end of participation, unless any stimuli are set up to be shown outside of fullscreen mode (e.g. website stimuli opened to a new tab).

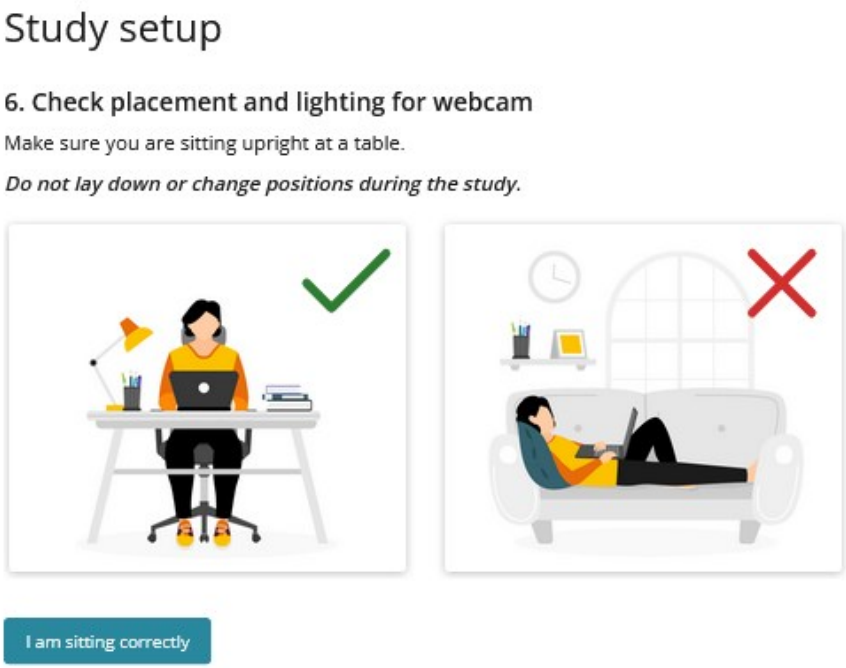


3. *Check placement and lighting for webcam*pages provide instructions

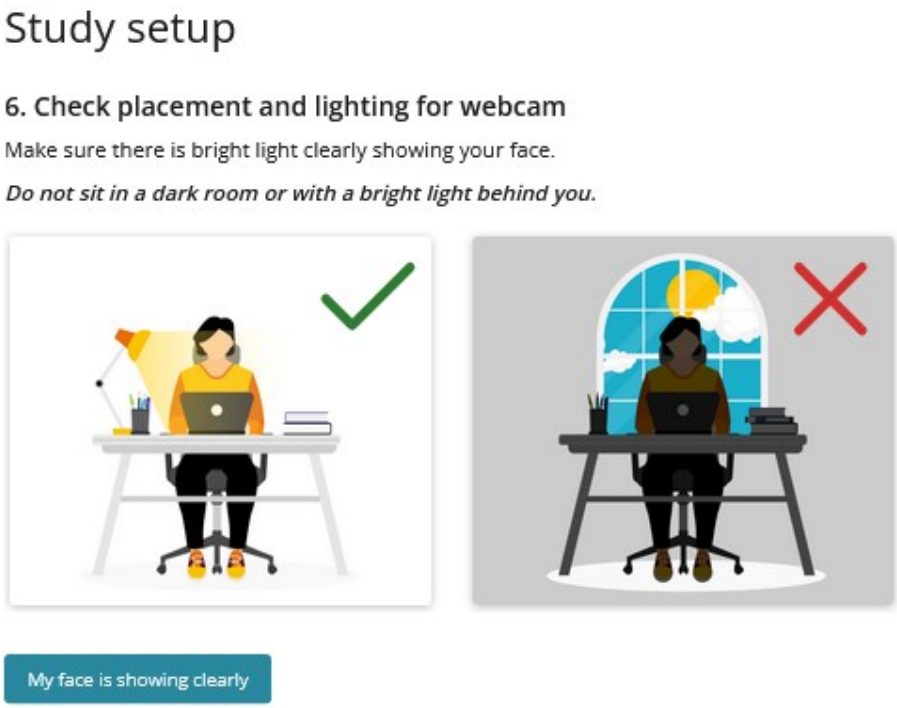
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about positioning (of the respondent and computer) and lighting during study participation.

a. Instruction about computer placement and participant positioning:



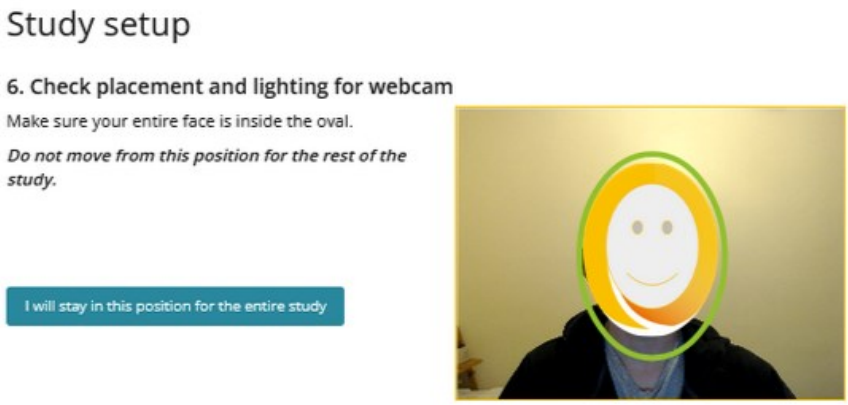
b. Instructions about lighting:

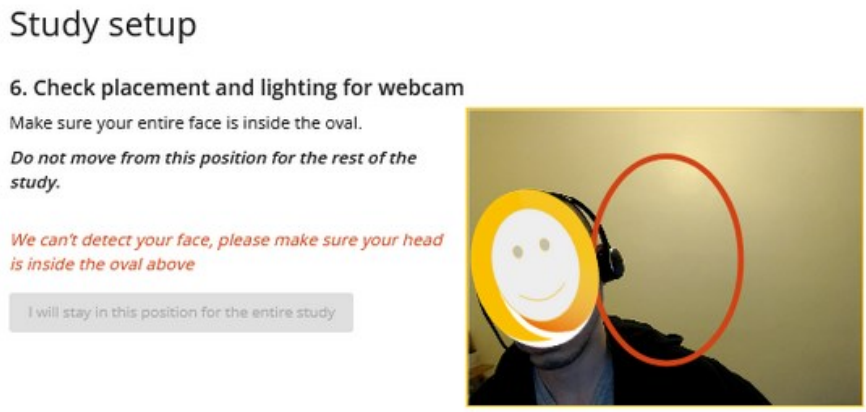


c. Live feedback showing camera view and the oval area where respondent's face should be seen. A green oval is shown when a face is detected in the expected region, otherwise a red oval appears. A face must be detected to proceed (unless *Allow*

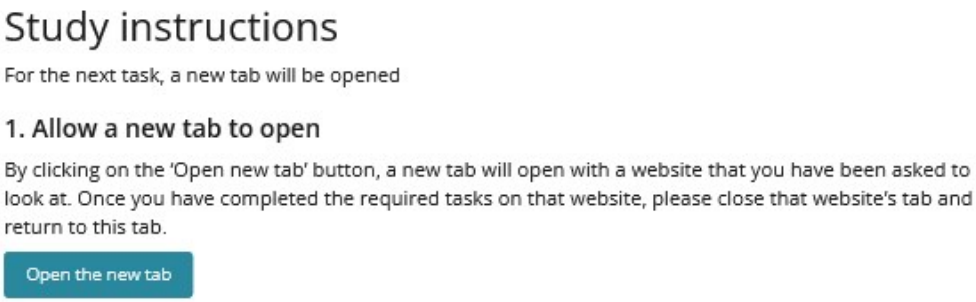
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skipping after timeout is enabled in study settings, where the study will proceed after 25 seconds).





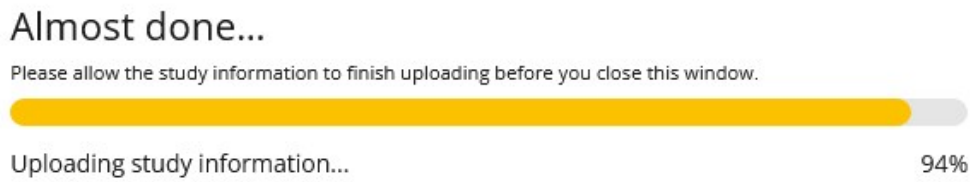
4. A *Study instructions* page is shown before the start of the study. Clicking on *Open the new tab* will begin study participation.

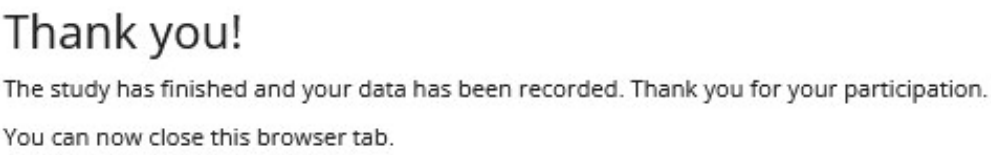


5. Eye tracker calibration
6. Study stimuli and data collection
7. At the conclusion of study participation, data files are automatically uploaded to my.imotions.com. A page will show the upload progress. When the upload is complete, a "Thank you" message appears, indicating that the study is finished. Note: If the *Data upload alternative* is

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enabled in study settings, respondents will be provided with a download page instead of the upload page. Respondents will be instructed to download their data files and send them to the email address entered in study settings.





8. If *Redirect options* are enabled with a *Study completed URL* in study settings, the study will conclude with redirection to that URL.

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